

10 - Meeting Minutes

Project: Dragon Merchant Guild (*Working Title*)

Document Version: 1.0

Status: Living Project Record

Purpose

The Meeting Minutes document records important project discussions, design decisions, and conclusions reached throughout development.

Although this project is primarily developed by a single person, every significant design discussion—whether with AI, friends, mentors, professors, or through personal reflection—represents a "meeting."

These records explain **why** important decisions were made.

Future revisions should always consult previous meeting notes before overturning established design decisions.

Guiding Principle

Code explains what the project does.

Meeting Minutes explain why it does it.

When to Create Meeting Minutes

Create a new meeting whenever one or more significant decisions are made regarding:

- Gameplay
- Architecture
- Worldbuilding
- User Interface
- Curriculum integration
- Project scope
- Refactoring direction

- AI workflow
- Development philosophy

Minor implementation details generally do not require meeting records.

Meeting Template

Meeting Number

Example

Meeting #012

Date

YYYY-MM-DD

Participants

Example

- Project Developer
- ChatGPT

Additional participants may include:

- Friends
 - Classmates
 - Professors
 - Future collaborators
-

Primary Topic

Summarize the purpose of the discussion.

Example

"Designing the dragon classification system."

Discussion Summary

Briefly summarize the major ideas discussed.

Avoid recording every sentence.

Instead, focus on the reasoning.

Decisions Made

List every important conclusion.

Example

✓ Dragons should be animals before workers.

✓ Humans adapt to dragons.

✓ Dragons possess instincts rather than job abilities.

Reasoning

Explain *why* those decisions were chosen.

Future You should understand the logic without needing to reread the entire conversation.

Alternatives Considered

Record notable alternatives that were discussed.

Example

Alternative:

Categorize dragons only by profession.

Rejected because:

It made dragons feel like RPG classes rather than believable species.

Questions Left Open

Not every meeting answers everything.

Record unresolved topics.

Example

- Should dragon breeding exist?
 - How should reputation affect politics?
 - Will seasons become part of the game?
-

Action Items

Concrete next steps.

Examples

- Update Dragon Codex.
 - Create Bestiary.
 - Implement prototype.
 - Research merchant guild history.
-

Follow-Up Required?

Yes / No

If Yes

Reference the future meeting once completed.

Example Meeting

Meeting #004

Date

2026-07-20

Participants

Developer

ChatGPT

Primary Topic

How should dragons be categorized?

Discussion Summary

Several approaches were considered.

Initially dragons were grouped entirely by profession.

This quickly created the impression that dragons existed only to perform jobs.

A second approach separated biological classification from human usage.

This resulted in a more believable ecosystem.

Decisions Made

✓ Every dragon belongs to exactly one ecological class.

✓ Dragons may belong to multiple guild professions.

✓ Profession classifications are human inventions.

✓ Ecology should always come first.

Reasoning

Separating biology from professions makes dragons feel like genuine wildlife instead of fantasy machinery.

Guilds simply discovered practical uses for behaviors that already existed.

Alternatives Considered

Profession-only classification.

Rejected because it weakened immersion.

Questions Left Open

How many ecological classes should exist?

Action Items

Create Dragon Codex.

Design foundational dragon species.

Follow-Up Required

No

Decision Log

For quick reference, maintain a running index of major project decisions.

Example

ID	Decision	Status
D-001	Game begins as console application	Active
D-002	Dragons use instincts instead of abilities	Active
D-003	Merchant guild theme	Active
D-004	AI acts as teacher, not co-developer	Active
D-005	Guild ranks issued by Merchant Council	Active

If a decision changes later, update its status rather than deleting it.

Example:

Superseded

Deprecated

Replaced

Experimental

This preserves the project's historical reasoning.

Decision Rules

Whenever a previous decision is challenged:

1. Locate the original meeting.
2. Review its reasoning.
3. Decide whether the original assumptions still hold.
4. Record the new decision.
5. Link both meetings together.

Never overwrite history.

Projects evolve.

The record should evolve with them.

Tips for Writing Good Minutes

Good meeting minutes should answer:

- What problem were we solving?
- What options were discussed?
- Why was one option selected?
- What assumptions were made?
- What should happen next?

Avoid recording conversations word-for-word.

Capture ideas instead.

Final Reminder

Every important design decision represents knowledge gained.

Documenting those decisions protects future development from repeating old debates.

The goal is not to preserve every conversation.

The goal is to preserve the wisdom that emerged from them.

Closing Thought

Memory fades.

Documentation remembers.

Every completed meeting becomes another piece of the project's institutional memory, allowing Future You—and any future collaborators—to understand not only what was built, but why it was worth building that way.